

The Lost Sheep & The Lost Coin



SCRIPTURE · Luke 15:1–10

The Lost Sheep & The Lost Coin · ESV

MAIN MESSAGE

God loves us deeply, even as we are far away from Him and lost in our sin, and He takes the initiative to seek and save lost people, moving heaven and earth to bring us home. When the lost are found—when even one sinner repents and turns to Him—God (and heaven) rejoices with overflowing joy.

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

- 01** Where have you believed you had to earn closeness to God?
- 02** Where do you currently see yourself: drifting, being pursued, or resisting God?

Discovering Truth

Jesus tells these parables in response to a clear tension. Sinners are gathering around Him, and religious men are criticizing Him for it. In their system, closeness to God was earned through discipline and separation. Jesus confronts that directly by showing that God does not distance Himself from lost men; He moves toward them. These stories reveal that the heart of God is not passive, but actively pursuing those who are far from Him.

01 · PARABLE ONE

The Lost Sheep

The lost sheep represents a man who has wandered away. He is not where he is supposed to be, and on his own, he cannot find his way back. The shepherd does not ignore him or wait for him to return. He leaves the ninety-nine and goes after the one with urgency and intention. This shows that no man is overlooked or insignificant to God.

02 · PARABLE TWO

The Lost Coin

The lost coin represents value that is still present, even when it is lost. The woman does not dismiss it—she searches carefully and relentlessly until she finds it. This shows that a man's worth does not disappear when he is lost. God does not define men by their condition, but by their value to Him.

These parables reveal the heart of God. He does not wait for men to fix themselves—He moves toward them. That pursuit ultimately leads to Jesus, who came to seek and save the lost and gave His life to bring men back into a relationship with God. Every man apart from Him is lost, whether it is obvious or hidden behind success and discipline. But when a man is found—when he turns back to God—there is celebration. Heaven rejoices.

Key Points

01

God does not wait for men to find their way back—He actively pursues them with intention and urgency.

02

Your value does not disappear when you are lost; God pursues you because of who you are to Him, not how you're performing.

03

The real question is not whether God is pursuing you, but whether you will recognize your need and respond to be found.

GROUP DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

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| 01 Where in your life have you drifted away from where you know you should be? | 04 What is keeping you from fully responding to God's pursuit right now? |
| 02 How have you seen God pursue you even when you weren't pursuing Him? | 05 How should God's pursuit of you change the way you view and engage other men? |
| 03 Where have you believed your value was diminished because of failure or distance from God? | |

Personal Reflection

Most men live like it's on them to figure life out, prove themselves, and earn their place. That mindset shapes how they see God. They either perform for Him or drift when they feel like they've failed. Jesus makes it clear—that's not how it works. You were lost, and God came after you fully through the cross. Once you've been found, you don't stay passive. You don't sit back while men around you drift. You step in. You pursue. If your life is only about you, you've missed the point.

PERSONAL REFLECTION QUESTIONS

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| 01 Where are you currently trying to prove yourself instead of receiving your identity from God? | 03 How do you separate your worth from performance, status, or results in your daily life? |
| 02 In your environment (team, work, family), where do you tend to stay passive instead of pursuing others? | 04 Think of one man in your life right now who is drifting, and what step will you take toward him this week? |